

RetailzPOS — "Counter Culture" Testimonial Video Series Concept

Prepared: July 29, 2026 **Scope:** A themed, repeatable video testimonial series for RetailzPOS, built around liquor store and smoke shop owners specifically. Designed to feel like a mini-documentary about the business first, a product story second — not a generic "here's why I like this software" talking-head clip.

A note on the reference videos: The two YouTube links you shared ([jg5hWAaE0vs](#) , [xCWQYfJEeqU](#)) couldn't be pulled in this environment — YouTube blocks the fetch tools available here, and search turned up nothing tied to those specific video IDs. Rather than guess at their content, everything below is built from the direction you gave directly: catchy, themed, story-first, not generic. If you can describe what specifically drew you to those two — pacing, interview style, how product and story were woven together — send that over and I'll sharpen this concept against it.

1. The series name: "Counter Culture"

You floated "My RetailzPOS Story" as a placeholder — the instinct behind it (personal, ownership-driven, not corporate) is right, but the name itself reads like a testimonial series, which is exactly what you said you don't want. Here's a sharper option, plus two alternates.

Recommended: Counter Culture

The double meaning does the work for you: the literal store counter, and the countercultural identity both target verticals actually have. Smoke shops have real countercultural roots — glass art, head-shop history, a community that's always defined itself against the mainstream. Independent liquor stores have their own version of this: the anti-big-box, "we actually know what's in this bottle" identity that's core to how they compete against chains. The name doesn't need to explain itself in a tagline — it already tells you this is a series about independent retailers with real identity, not a feature demo.

How it reads as a franchise: "Counter Culture: [Owner Name] — [Store Name], [City]" as the episode title format. It's ownable, it's a real phrase people will remember, and it doesn't box you into liquor or smoke shop specifically if the series ever expands to convenience.

Alternates, if you want options to react to

- **The Reorder** — retail/inventory term (running low, reordering stock) doubled with the loyalty/repeat-business meaning (a customer who reorders, a business that keeps coming back to what works). Quieter, more product-adjacent than Counter Culture, but still a real double meaning rather than a generic phrase.
- **Open Sign** — evokes the daily ritual of flipping the sign, opening the doors, starting the day — a strong cold-open visual hook built into the name itself, but less distinctive as a franchise brand than Counter Culture.

(Worth a quick trademark/existing-use check on whichever name you like before committing — "Counter Culture" is evocative enough that it's worth confirming it's not already heavily claimed in retail media.)

2. What makes this not a generic testimonial

The standard SaaS testimonial video opens with the owner introducing themselves and the software, then lists 2-3 features they like, then says "I'd recommend it." It's forgettable because the business is just a backdrop for the product pitch. This series flips that: **the business is the story, and RetailzPOS is the thing that lets that story keep going.** Three structural choices make that real instead of aspirational:

1. **Cold open on the business, not the owner talking to camera.** First 10-15 seconds are pure vérité — hands sorting bottles, a regular customer walking in and being greeted by name, glass being arranged in a case, the specific texture of that shop. No introduction yet. This is the single biggest lever for making it feel like a documentary instead of a testimonial — generic testimonials almost always open with "Hi, I'm [name] from [store]," and skipping that is what signals "this is different" in the first three seconds.
 2. **The pain point is a specific anecdote, not a category of problem.** Not "inventory management was hard" — something like "we had a Friday night rush during a holiday weekend and I genuinely couldn't tell you what we had left in the walk-in without walking back there myself." Specificity is what makes it feel real instead of scripted.
 3. **The product appears through footage, not through the owner's mouth.** Show the age-verification prompt at checkout, show a tablet inventory check mid-conversation, show the loyalty lookup happening naturally during a sale — while the owner talks about what changed for their business, not what the software does. Keep marketing language out of the owner's actual dialogue; let them talk like themselves.
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3. Episode structure template

A consistent shape across every episode is what makes this read as a series instead of one-off videos — viewers should recognize the format by episode two.

Beat	Length (in a 3-5 min hero cut)	What happens
Cold open	0:00-0:15	Vérité texture of the shop — no dialogue, no logo yet. Sound design (bell on the door, register beep, bottles clinking) carries it.
Title card	0:15-0:20	"COUNTER CULTURE" + store name, city. Simple, doesn't overstay.
Who they are	0:20-1:15	The owner's actual story — why this business, why this specialty, how long they've been at it. This is where the business's real identity shows up: a family legacy, a curated selection, a neighborhood role.
The specific problem	1:15-2:00	One real, specific moment where the old way broke down — told as an anecdote, not a category.
What changed	2:00-3:15	RetailzPOS shown through real usage footage while the owner talks about the outcome in their own words — not a feature list.
The signature question	3:15-3:45	Same question asked in every episode (see Section 4) — this is the recurring device that ties the series together across stores and verticals.
Close	3:45-end	A legacy/identity line from the owner, then the closing card.

The closing card and tagline: "Every store has a story. What's yours?" — followed by the RetailzPOS logo and a simple demo CTA. Understated on purpose; the video already did the selling.

4. The signature recurring device

Every good documentary series has one thing that repeats episode to episode and becomes the thing people associate with the format. For this series, it's **one consistent closing question**, asked identically in every episode, cut in as its own beat near the end:

"What's the one thing about running a shop like this that people never guess?"

This works because it's not about the product at all — it invites a genuinely personal, often surprising answer (the regular who comes in every day at the same time, the thing about compliance nobody warns you about, the actual math on shrink) that makes each episode distinct even as the format stays identical. It also naturally surfaces authentic, unscripted moments that are far more shareable as short-form cutdowns than anything scripted could be.

A second, lighter recurring segment worth considering: **"The Regular"** — a 5-10 second cutaway mid-episode where the camera catches one loyal customer, on camera for just a moment, saying why they keep coming back to this specific store. It reinforces the "relationship the software helps scale" theme without RetailzPOS having to say it directly.

5. Two sample episode treatments

Concrete enough to hand to a video team or use as a shot-list starting point.

Episode concept: Liquor store — "The Curator"

Store archetype: An independent bottle shop, in business 15-20+ years, known in the neighborhood for a genuinely curated selection (not just volume) — the owner can talk knowledgeably about half the bottles on the shelf.

The story: Built the business on expertise and relationship — customers come in and ask "what should I try this week" the way they'd ask a friend. The specific problem: during a holiday rush, the owner realized they had no real way to know which regulars had gone quiet — someone who used to come in weekly for four years just... stopped, and the owner only noticed by accident months later.

What changed: RetailzPOS/Moolah Points flags exactly that — lapsed regulars, automatically, instead of by accident. Age verification shown as a background detail that "just works" rather than a talking point — the owner mentions it almost in passing, as one less thing to worry about, not a headline feature.

Signature question answer (illustrative): Something about the emotional weight of being trusted with people's taste — "people don't realize how much of this job is just remembering what someone likes."

Episode concept: Smoke shop — "The Glass"

Store archetype: A shop built around genuine product culture — local glass artists, a knowledgeable staff, a shop that treats itself as a craft retailer, not just a nicotine counter.

The story: The owner takes real pride in curation and guidance, similar energy to the liquor persona but with its own texture — talks about helping someone find the right piece, not just ringing up a sale. The specific problem: a fast Saturday afternoon where the register queue backed up because inventory and checkout weren't in sync, and a customer walked out rather than wait.

What changed: Speed and reliability at checkout, inventory that's actually accurate in real time, shown through footage of a fast, smooth sale during a busy moment.

A note on tone for this vertical specifically: given how much of this category's customer base is actively trying to moderate or quit (a real, well-documented pattern), the strongest version of this episode leans into curation, craft, and community — not consumption. An owner talking about helping someone find quality over quantity, or being a knowledgeable resource rather than a volume pusher, is both the most authentic story for this kind of shop and the safest, smartest positioning.

6. Production format — get more than one asset per shoot

Every episode shoot should be planned to output three tiers from the same footage, since a single 3-5 minute film is the wrong length for most of the places this will actually get watched:

1. **Hero cut (3-5 min)** — YouTube, website, sales/demo decks. The full story.
2. **Platform cutdowns (60-90 sec)** — Facebook, Instagram feed, LinkedIn. Trim to "who they are" + "what changed" + close; skip the slower narrative build.
3. **Vertical shorts (15-30 sec)** — Reels/TikTok/Shorts, built entirely around the signature-question answer or one striking vérité moment from the cold open. These are the pieces most likely to travel on their own, so treat the signature-question beat as a dedicated short, not just a trim of the long cut.

This also ties directly into the paid social lead-gen work already built for the owner-buyer audience (`moolahpoints-owner-leadgen-social-campaign-2026-07.md`) — the 60-90 second cutdowns are strong MOFU proof content, and a striking short can anchor a retargeting ad aimed at owners who've already engaged with other content.

7. Interview guide — the questions that get real answers

Ask these loosely, in conversation, not as a rigid script — but they're built to avoid the trap of the owner slipping into marketing language.

1. "How did you end up running this place?" (*not "tell us about your business" — too formal, invites a rehearsed answer*)
2. "What's something about this neighborhood/this store that only a regular would know?"

3. "Walk me through a moment when the old way of doing things really let you down." (*elicits the specific anecdote, not a category complaint*)
4. "What's different about a normal day now versus before?"
5. "What's the one thing about running a shop like this that people never guess?" (*the signature closer, every episode*)

Avoid asking directly "what's your favorite RetailzPOS feature" — that's the question that produces the generic testimonial you're trying to avoid. The product should come up naturally while answering questions 3 and 4, not as its own topic.

8. Next steps

- Pick a series name (or greenlight Counter Culture) so it can start showing up in outreach to candidate stores.
- Identify 2-3 candidate owners per vertical (liquor, smoke shop) who have a real story angle — the strongest episodes come from picking subjects with a genuine identity hook (legacy, curation, community role), not just picking the first willing customer.
- If you want, I can draft outreach messaging for asking existing RetailzPOS customers to participate, or build a one-page creative brief formatted for a video production team/freelancer to work from.